MIL-S-43829B
16 May 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-43829A
2 August 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SUSPENDERS, INDIVIDUAL EQUIPMENT BELT, LC-1

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers one type and size of equipment belt suspenders (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203	- Paper, Kraft, Untreated
V-T-285	- Thread, Polyester
DDD-L-20	- Label: For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use)
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8465

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MILITARY

MIL-B-543	- Buckles, Tongueless and Web Strap
MIL-W-4088	- Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon
MIL-W-5664	- Webbing, Textile, Elastic, Cotton
MIL-L-11075	- Loops, Strap Fastener
MIL-W-27265	- Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon Impregnated
MIL-L-35078	- Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification For
MIL-C-43128	- Cloth, Plain Weave, Nylon: Water Repellent, OG-106
MIL-C-43204	- Cloth, Spacer (Olefin)
MIL-W-43668	- Webbing, Textile, Bulked Nylon
MIL-S-43770/2	- Snap Hooks, Wire Body, Fixed Loop Eye, Side Retaining Closure

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	- Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731	- Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

2-2-323	- Suspenders, Individual Equipment Belt, LC-1; Assembly and Sections
2-2-324	- Suspenders, Individual Equipment Belt, LC-1; Details and Sections

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.

3.1.1 Standard samples. Samples of the end item, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.4). Variation from this document may appear in the sample in which case this document shall govern.

3.1.2 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.3).

* 3.2 Materials. The materials specified shall conform to applicable documents and requirements specified herein. Recycled materials may be used (see 6.6).

3.2.1 Cloth, nylon. The cloth for the pad cover shall be Olive Green 106, water repellent, nylon cloth conforming to MIL-C-43128 (see 6.5).

* 3.2.2 Cloth spacer. The spacer cloth for the pad shall conform to type II or III of MIL-C-43204, color optional.

3.2.3 Webbing, nylon, 2 1/4 inch in width. The webbing shall be dyed Olive Drab 7, shall conform to type VIIIc of MIL-W-4088, and shall be resin impregnated to conform to class R of MIL-W-27265.

3.2.4 Webbing, bulked nylon, 1 inch in width. The webbing shall be dyed Olive Drab 7 and shall conform to type III of MIL-W-43668.

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* 3.2.5 Webbing, elastic. The webbing shall be dyed OD 7 and shall conform to class 1, type II, 1 inch of MIL-W-5664.

3.2.6 Thread, polyester. The thread for all stitching shall conform to type I, class 1, subclass A or B of V-T-285. When subclass B thread is used, the nonwicking requirements shall not apply. Color shall be Olive Drab S-1 and shall show fastness to weathering equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, thread shall show good fastness to weathering. Sizes shall be E for bartacking and F for all stitching except bartacking.

3.2.7 Loops, strap fastener. The strap fastener loops shall conform to type I, style LL of MIL-L-11075.

3.2.8 Buckles, non-slip, 1 inch. The buckles shall conform to type V, class 3, size 1 inch of MIL-B-543.

* 3.2.9 Snap hooks, side retaining, 1-inch. The 1-inch side retaining snap hooks shall conform to SWZE2 of MIL-S-43770/2.

3.3 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to Drawings 2-2-323 and 2-2-324, and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitches, seams, and stitchings. All stitches, seams, and stitchings, except bartacking, shall be performed using stitch type 301, with 7 to 9 stitches per inch, and shall conform to FED-STD-751.

* 3.3.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all stitching, except W-W, shall be backstitched or overstitched 1 inch minimum except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. On W-W stitching, all ends shall be backstitched or overstitched 1/2-inch minimum. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be embedded in the materials sewn.

* 3.3.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1 inch (1/2 inch for box and W-W stitching) in back of the end of the stitching.

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b. Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch in back of the defective area (1/2 inch for W-W stitching), continue over the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1 inch (1/2 inch for box and W-W stitching) beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials and by restitching in the required manner.1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.3.1.2 Automatic stitching. Automatic stitching machines may be used to perform any of the stitch patterns provided that the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met, and that at least three tying, overlapping, or back stitches are used to secure the ends of the stitching.

3.3.1.3 Bartacking. Bartacking shall be free from thread breaks and loose stitching. Bartacking shall be as follows:

Length	Width	No. of stitches
1 ± 1/16 inch	1/8 ± 1/32 inch	42
3/4 ± 1/16 inch	1/8 ± 1/32 inch	42

3.3.1.4 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a maximum length of 1/4 inch.

3.3.2 Fusing of nylon webbing. Ends of webbing, including bias cuts, shall be fused smooth. Fusing of the webbing ends shall be accomplished prior to assembling for stitching. The apparatus used to fuse the webbing ends shall be capable of providing sufficient heat to provide a smooth edge with the cut ends of the webbing yarns all fused together.

3.3.3 Location marks. Location marks shall not be drilled. Printed markings shall not exceed 1/32 inch in width.

3.3.4 Repairs. Except as otherwise specified herein, repairs are not allowed to be made to the suspenders.

3.3.5 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting, and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.3 shall be removed from production and replaced with nondefective and properly matched components.

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3.4 Marking. The identification marking shall be applied in the location shown on Drawing 2-2-323 and shall conform to type IV, class 5 of DDD-L-20. The letters "US" shall be applied in the size characters and in the location indicated on Drawing 2-2-323 and shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. Fastness of class 9 marking shall be as specified for class 5 marking.

* 3.5 Workmanship. The finished suspenders shall be clean. The textile components shall be free of defects, such as holes, tears, loose weaving, or unfused ends. The hardware shall be free of corroded areas, sharp edges, or unfinished areas.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

* 4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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* 4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

* 4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether cut lengths, cut parts, fabricated parts before assembly including stitch margins and gage, and markings for location of components are in accordance with specified requirements. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

* 4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of suspenders. The sample unit shall be one suspender. The inspection level shall be II, and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 15.0 for total (major and minor) combined defects.

TABLE I. Classification of visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Fabric	Hole, cut, tear, smash, broken or missing yarn, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance, approximately 3 feet	X	
	Shade bar or abrasion mark		X

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Webbing (nylon)	Any hole, cut, tear, or smash	X	
	Not firmly and tightly woven, edges frayed or scalloped	X	
	Multiple floats or other misweave		X
	Abrasion mark, slub, or broken end or pick		X
	Cut ends not fused as specified	X	
Webbing, elastic	Any hole, cut, or tear	X	
Hardware	Broken or malformed failing to serve intended purpose, corroded area, burr, or sharp edge	X	
	Finish omitted or not as specified	X	
	Area of no finish		X
	Not assembled as specified	X	
	Not specified type, style, class, size	X	
Open seam	Less than 1/2 inch		X
	1/2 inch or more	X	
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches occur. On double stitched seams, a seam shall be considered open when either one or both sides of the seam are open.		
Raw edge (on edge required to be finished)	More than 1/2 inch when securely caught in stitching	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Raw edge (on edge required to be finished) (continued)	NOTE: Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as open seam.		
Run-off (see open seam)			
Seam and stitch type	Wrong seam or stitch type	X	
Bartacks	One or more bartacks omitted	X	
	Any bartack not as specified or not in specified location		X
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in a loosely exposed bobbin or top thread; tight resulting in excessive puckering of fabric on seam		X
Stitches per inch (except on bartack stitching)	Up to two stitches less than minimum specified		X
	Three or more stitches less than minimum specified	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified		X

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Stitches per inch (except on bartack stitching) (continued)			
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the fabric in order to sew over heavy seams or in turning corners shall be classified as follows: a. Within the minor defect classification - no defect b. Within the major defect classification - minor defect		
Thread breaks	Not overstitched as specified		X
	NOTE: Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.		
Ends of stitching (not held down by other stitching or turned under in a hem)	Not secured as specified		X
"W" stitching	One row of stitching missing		X
	Two or more rows of stitching missing	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Components and assembly	Any component part omitted or not as specified or any operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	X	
	One or more rows of stitching omitted	X	
	One or more needle chews	X	
	Any mend, darn, patch, or splice		X
Location markings	Drilled		X
Front straps with elastic keeper	Front straps not positioned through 1-inch non-slip buckle and elastic keeper as indicated on drawings		X
Piece "B"	Ends of webbing not turned under and caught in stitching	X	
	Edges or ends of folded webbing not even with edges of piece "A"		X
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains clearly noticeable		X
	Thread ends not trimmed to 1/4-inch maximum length		X
Marking, "US" and identification	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced		X

* 4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of suspenders. The sample unit shall be one suspender. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

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TABLE II. Dimensional defects

Examine	Defect
Location dimensions, including assembly, stitch margins, and gage	Not within specified tolerance

4.4.5 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number of suspenders per container is more or less than specified 1/

1/ For this defect one intermediate container shall be examined.

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* 4.4.6 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded with required straps as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

* 5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The suspenders shall be folded in half (sewn webbing on inside) by superimposing one padded shoulder section over the other. The attached straps and hardware shall be placed on top of the padded shoulder sections to form a compact bundle measuring approximately 16 1/2 by 3 by 1 1/4 inches. The bundle shall be securely tied with tape or twine in not less than two places to prevent the enclosed straps and hardware from slipping out. Pad cover marking shall be visible to the outside of the bundle.

5.1.2 Commercial. The suspenders shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Eighty suspenders, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Suspenders, bundled level A, shall be packed flat, eight in length, one in width, and ten in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be

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approximately 24 1/2 inches in length, 17 inches in width, and 12 1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Eighty suspenders, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Suspenders, bundled level A, shall be packed flat, eight in length, one in width, and ten in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be approximately 24 1/2 inches in length, 17 inches in width, and 12 1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Suspenders, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), suspenders, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet types shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV, or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be No. 3 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

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5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The suspenders are designed for use with the individual equipment belt on which are suspended items of field equipment such as water canteen, ammunition cases, and other items required by the soldier in the field. The suspenders come in one size only and are intended to fit individuals of all size ranges.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1.2, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
e. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

* 6.3 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Standard samples. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.5 Fusing of cloth edges (cut). The cut edges of the nylon cloth specified in 3.2.1 are subject to fraying during the process of handling the cut parts during fabrication of the suspenders. It has been found that fusing of the cut edges of the cloth will prevent fraying.

6.6 Recycled material. The contractor is encouraged to use recycled material when practical, provided that it meets the requirements of this document (see 3.2).

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* 6.7 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-43829B	Suspenders, Individual Equipment Belt, LC-1

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Includes Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

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